GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

June 27th, 2025
Week 26
Volume 273, Issue 1191

Highlights:

- **Finally here.**
- **Positive news.**
- **Transition.**
- **Certification.**
- **Price slump.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"Don't be the one to face problems. Become the one who delivers them."

– Kamal Datta

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

HKC IN FORCE!

After decades of ongoing efforts, the Hong Kong Convention (HKC) finally entered into force this week with big changes underway for the industry, particularly in the Bangladeshi and Pakistani markets who still have a lot of work to do and catch up to the strides India has already made in upgrading their facilities over the last decade. This is certainly great news for stakeholders, ship owners, cash buyers, recyclers, and the environment at large, as positive strides at improving industry standards will further serve as a catalyst in the crucial circular world of shipping, we are all in today.

Of course, in the short term, there is likely to be a testy period of transition whilst everyone in the industry gets accustomed to the changing regulations, inward formality procedures, and additional documents required when a vessel is being transacted for HKC recycling from here on. Of note, documentation and procedures might change as the initial phase in period settles. In the interim however, owners / cash buyers seeking to deliver units into the Indian sub-continent ship recycling markets will now have to include IHM reports part I, II and III, along with a 'Ready for Recycling' certificate from the relevant flag state, all gift wrapped in the yard specific HKC and ISO certification by various classes. Owners now need to ensure these formalities are timed well with the arrival of the vessel in order to avoid unintended delays and potentially miss beaching tides.

At the Macro end of the spectrum, we continue to see the fallout from the recent attacks in Iran as oil has been the biggest beneficiary of global sufferance as it tumbled over 11% just last week, ending it at about USD 66/barrel. The U.S. Dollar is similarly getting hammered as it reported barely any negative changes against any of the recycling nation currencies (except Turkey). The supply of tonnage at the bidding table on the other hand, seems to be gearing up again as some older units continues to slip into the recycling stream (as confirmed by Bangladesh's and even India's waterfronts this week), as freight rates declined over 2.1% and the Cape index declining the most last week at 5.3%. Trade wars continue, major ports return to turning empty for the most part, and economies are bracing for the next thoughtless policy out of the White House.

Meanwhile, prices and demand have slumped over the last couple of months and continue to do so, in the lead up to the HKC even though we have seen few private sales realized through it all, it's clear that both owners and cash buyers are chasing down a market and will likely continue to. Local steel plate prices are declining at the most convenient locations while flatlining in others and port reports in key locations (except Bangladesh) are turning sour through the rains. As tariff ping pong continues, Trump surprisingly confirmed trade deals being done with India, which should help this market in the near future given the incessant spiral state its plate and currency has been in.

Turkey, we just have nothing left to add other than the same ole' bad news.

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 27 of 2025 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

NEW DAWN!

Collapse.

The Bangladeshi market has (unsurprisingly?) slumped to the bottom of the sub-continent pricing board for the first time in months, with some abysmal levels and demand emanating from the few local buyers who are available to bid on tonnage at the tables. Yet, desperate owners and cash buyers are biting the bullet and committing units to open yards as Chattogram anchorage reported nearly 86K LDT including a large Ore carrier, contradicting the true state of the market while representing the real state of present-day recycling.

HKC buyers taken.

Most of the recently HKC approved buyers have filled their plots with some of the larger units recently sold (such as a VLOC and several LNGs) so their collective appetites have certainly been satiated for the time being. These ongoing deliveries are likely to those who are on the path to getting their HKC accreditations and received NOCs on the vessel's idling outside. The entry of the Hong Kong Convention into force is finally the realization of much hard work on behalf of all stakeholders across the industry in Bangladesh, and whilst yard upgrades and infrastructure works are still underway for a number of yards, the next quarter (and beyond) will be a brand-new dawn for the forward thinking in the Bangladeshi ship recycling market.

Hard work realised.

Fundamentals have been the prime movers of local offerings and current depth of demand given that local steel plate prices fell by about USD 8/Ton, further diminishing local margins, but the Bangladeshi Taka also declined and ended the week at BDT 122.30 against the U.S. Dollar while having declined even further (at the time of writing) towards BDT 122.60. Moreover, with prices collapsing, reports of offers below USD 400/Ton are also coming forth as end-of-life values of these aging assets continue to collapse under the weight of global economic turmoil that has been aggravated by declining local demand and the implementation of HKC regulations as cutting becomes slower, while costs are simultaneously expected to increase at the same time due to slower recycling processes and mounting L/C interest charges.

Printing.

With not much going on other than rains and barely any steel sales to steel mills amidst declining plate levels, July looks like it's already printing itself on the wall.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

BEEN THERE, DONE THAT!

As the industry leaders in the safe and responsible HKC recycling of ships, India has certainly been a showstopper of late, with a magnanimous sense of 'been there done that' whilst Bangladesh and Pakistan desperately try to catch up as the HKC entered into force this week. Alang buyers have certainly been trying to absorb much of the excess tonnage that has been unable to head to Chattogram or Gadani of late, primarily due to ongoing HKC delays and increased regulations / certifications required.

Others catch up.

But prices in the sub-continent and India in particular, have indeed been subdued over these quieter monsoon months, and as with Bangladesh, there is the danger of sinking below 400/LDT on certain poor condition, less favoured units including bulkers given that Bangladeshi recyclers are already dropping indications in the high USD 39X/Ton this week, surprising everyone in the industry and displacing India for 2nd place on the market rankings.

Unable to absorb.

Local port position, meanwhile, continues to take in tonnage as an impressive number (under current times) of vessels made it to anchorage as nearly 50K tons (including a bunch of tankers) of recyclable units are waiting to get delivered to their respective recyclers, and have been impressively doing so week after week.

India's successful negotiations with the Whie House also seem to be bearing fruit this week as Trump officially announced India as being a partner to ongoing tariff negotiations, which should ease some of the erratic stresses that Alang recyclers are currently battling The Indian Rupee too, skyrocketed against the U.S. Dollar climbing over 1.2% against the Dollar as it ended the week at Rs 85.49, while local steel plate prices continued to do the opposite for the local mindset and decline again, closing the week out at USD 426.30/Ton.

Below 400/LDT.

With the number of tankers coming in, it sure does seem like the Iranian war has had some effect as these rare Gas Free for Hot Works gems coming into India during the HKC transition, is certainly impressive at this early stage.

India seems to be heading into a busier July than most expected despite Bangladesh making strides towards environmentally friendly recycling, yet, with the outlook on respective anchorages this week, this rainy summer seems to be going rather well for Inia.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

RIGHTING THE WRONGS!

Underway.

The Pakistani budget and various announcements made by the government and PSBA in recent weeks have finally left a positive impression on the domestic ship recycling community after years of unintended neglect. Indeed, IHMs will have to be issued for any incoming vessel deliveries and provisional DASR certificates showing that select yards have begun upgrade works to an acceptable level, will always remain at the discretion of the PSBA and ministry of affairs, on any incoming sales / vessels.

DASR certs.

As it stands, Pakistan is now the firmest market in the sub-continent for any new vessel sales (first time in many months) – but there is still some uncertainty / ambiguity over how long it will take to get various ministry permissions in this new regulatory HKC landscape the shipping industry has to operate in now. This effect has certainly played itself out at the waterfront given that there have been no new arrivals in Gadani over the last couple of weeks and the sole idling member of the waterfront is finally on the beach this week.

Meanwhile, fundamentals continue to rock the already degraded state of local recyclers mindsets as the PKR continues to decline week after week, ending this one, at Rs, 85.45 against the U.S. Dollar while local steel plate prices remained flatlined at USD 616/Ton – the highest of margins for recyclers in the industry today. The negative trajectory of the PKR is certainly worrisome for local recyclers as after the budget and a reported tax on local recycling imports, the weakening currency will continue to make it that much more expensive for recyclers in the short run, resulting in misplaced deliveries.

Firmest placed.

Moreover, with HKC rules currently in place and with no direction or ability to garner the true status of domestic yard upgrades, deliveries will certainly face problems across July and perhaps bleeding into the next quarter as not a single yard thus far has been certified. So, if you break it, you buy it, at the currently declining levels from this market that has unexpectedly found itself atop the market rankings at a time the HKC has entered into force and this destination is unable to import any.

Firmest

Overall, neighboring India seems geared up for a wet summer more than Pakistan – and with tonnage already flowing in, including tankers, Pakistan seems to be sidelined from most ship owners and cash buyers for the time-being. At least until confidence in this market's ability to effectively import ships, matures in the weeks ahead.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

ZILCH!

Other than the falling Lira and local recyclers forming independent Cash Buying entities to directly negotiate units with potential EU owners, there is nothing we can report from this market for this week.

Cash buyers.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 26 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Pakistan	**Weak**	420 / LDT	440 / LDT	450 / LDT
2	India	**Weak**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
3	Bangladesh	**Weak**	400 / LDT	420 / LDT	430 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Weak**	250 / LDT	260 / LDT	270 / LDT

WEIRD ONES!!

- *The first English scientists to receive a preserved platypus were so absolutely 100% convinced it was a hoax that he nearly took the specimen apart trying to find evidence that it had been assembled from multiple different animals.*
- *The fax machine was invented in the 1800s, well before the telephone. It's not the fax machine we know today, but the "original" fax machine (aka the electric printing telegraph) was invented in 1843 by Alexander Baine. In contrast, the telephone was invented decades later in 1876 by Alexander Graham Bell. Big century for Alexanders, it seems!*
- *A pony is not a baby horse. A baby horse is called a foal. A pony is a horse that as an adult is below a certain height.*
- *Zebras are black with white stripes. Though they might look like they're white and have black stripes at first glance, underneath their fur, zebras have dark skin. They grow both black and white fur, and their black fur gets its color from melanocyte cells. Their white fur has deactivated melanocytes, which means that active melanocytes — or black fur — is their "default" color, thus making them black with white stripes.*
- *Words that are spelled the same but pronounced with emphasis on different syllables are actually indicative of the part of speech they are. Stress on the first syllable is a noun. Stress on the last syllable is a verb. Examples: CON-tract and con-TRACT. The former is a noun (sign this contract), whereas the latter is a verb (the muscles contract). Same with record, address, impact, object, and a few others.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
July 06 – Ashura	June 22 – June 30 July 08 – July 16 July 21 – July 29

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
July 05 – Ashura	July 11 – July 14 July 24 – July 27

BANK HOLIDAYS		
CHINA	**PAKISTAN**	**TURKEY**
No holidays in July	July 01 – Bank Holiday July 05 – 06 – Ashoora	July 15 – Democracy & National Solidarity Day

Prices indicated above are as reported in the market and are not necessarily accurate. This information is provided without prejudice and is given in good faith and without any guarantees whatsoever. While every care has been taken in the preparation of this report, no liability can be accepted for any loss incurred in any way whatsoever by any person relying on the information contained herein. Opinions expressed herein may be deemed subjective and arbitrary. This WEEKLY is intended only for the person or entity to which it is addressed and may contain confidential and/or privileged material. Any review, retransmission, dissemination, or other use of this information by persons or entities other than the intended recipient is prohibited.

ALANG - Port Position as of June 27, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Bitumen Princess	2,884	Asphalt Tanker	Delivered June 27
2	Conica Atlas	20,001	Oil Tanker	Arrived June 13
4	Nirvana	9,623	Oil Tanker	Arrived May 07
5	Contract II	9,453	Oil Tanker	Arrived June 25
Total Tonnage		**41,961**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of June 27, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Abraham M	8,997	Bulk Carrier	Arrived June 23
2	Ang Min	11,243	Bulk Carrier	Arrived June 23
3	*Berge Fuji*	*37,379*	*Ore Carrier*	*Delivered June 26*
4	*Gas Soechi XXIII*	*2,180*	*LPG*	*Delivered June 26*
5	*Hugo*	*2,631*	*Cargo Vessel*	*Delivered June 26*
6	Naso (Under Tow)	23,292	Bulk Carrier	Arrived June 27
		85,723		

GADANI - Port Position as of June 27, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Pacific K*	*10,386*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered June 19*
Total Tonnage		**10,386**		

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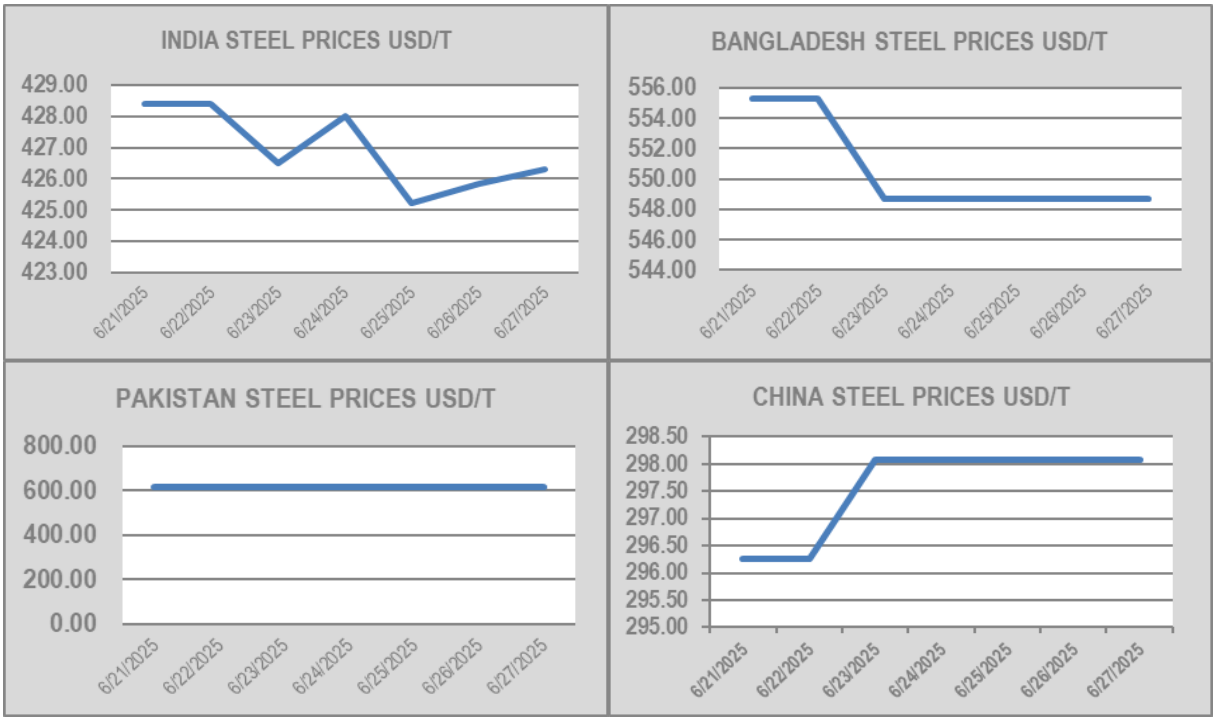
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
6/21/2025	428.41	37,100.00	616.04	174,000.00	555.28	66,500.00	296.25
6/22/2025	428.41	37,100.00	616.04	174,000.00	555.28	66,500.00	296.25
6/23/2025	426.51	37,000.00	616.04	174,000.00	548.68	66,500.00	298.07
6/24/2025	428.01	36,800.00	616.04	174,000.00	548.68	66,500.00	298.07
6/25/2025	425.24	36,600.00	616.04	174,000.00	548.68	66,500.00	298.07
6/26/2025	425.85	36,500.00	616.04	174,000.00	548.68	66,500.00	298.07
6/27/2025	426.30	36,500.00	616.04	174,000.00	548.68	66,500.00	298.07



www.gmsinc.net GMS_Leadership GMS Leadership snp@gmsinc.net

Athens, Greece Tel: +30.210.899.0669
Cumberland, USA Tel: +1.301.759.9240
Hamburg, Germany Tel: +49.40. 3197.9963
Shanghai, China Tel: +86.216.075.1900
Singapore Tel: +65.6823.8037
Bhavnagar, India Tel: +91.278.300.5253
Dubai, UAE Tel: +971.4.423.0720
New York, USA: +1.240.505.9716
Seoul, South Korea Tel: +82.10.4650.0720
Tokyo, Japan Tel: +81.3.5453.6311